

Graphics cards

Nothing sets the pulse racing as a good old graphics performance showdown



NVIDIA GeForce GTX TITAN X
Price: ₹86,990

The desktop graphics scenario saw a tumultuous conflict this year as AMD's R9 Fury X ended up being a competitive model against NVIDIA's offerings. For about 2-3 years we'd seen NVIDIA's single-GPU SKUs wiping the floor with whatever AMD had to offer and with a financial crisis at hand, AMD couldn't offer more than rebadged GPUs of its older technologies with little performance increments.

Zero1 Winner

NVIDIA GeForce GTX TITAN X

Coming from a family of goliaths, the NVIDIA GeForce GTX TITAN X was yet another ace performer with a massive 12 GB of RAM to boast for. Pushing the boundaries of performance each year, NVIDIA's TITAN sure did live up to expectations. The massive RAM cluster is only one of the many signs that show how the industry is moving up towards making 4K the next resolution standard that'll be accepted by one and all. After all it cranks out 50 FPS or more in almost all AAA games running at 4K while previously you'd have to get a dual GPU card to get the same or more. The R9 290X, GTX 980 and 780 Ti were all great performers at 4K but for the generation of AAA games

that were around back then, current titles like Shadow of Mordor and GTA V will have certain scenarios where you'd experience inconvenient stuttering but the TITAN X makes those go away. However, the NVIDIA GeForce GTX TITAN X is still no match for dual GPU cards or flagships in SLI / CrossFireX so you might as well spend the same amount getting two NVIDIA GeForce GTX 980 Ti and SLI them to get a lot more performance.

Runner-ups

ZOTAC and ASUS GeForce GTX 980 Ti

What do you get for roughly half the price of a TITAN X and performs just about the same? The NVIDIA GeForce GTX 980 Ti of course! And we didn't see any lack of competition here when it came to brands with ZOTAC's GTX 980 Ti AMP! Extreme coming in at second and the ASUS STRIX GTX 980 Ti DC3OC coming in at third. With a fairly straightforward condition of performance being the sole parameter for the Zero1 Awards, it shouldn't come as a surprise that ZOTAC's GTX 980 Ti AMP! Extreme takes the crown. It's clocked at 1253 MHz and has quite the cooling capacity to handle the heat it generates.

And right at its heels is the ASUS STRIX GTX 980 Ti DC3OC with a base



ZOTAC GeForce GTX 980 Ti
Price: ₹59,338



ASUS GeForce GTX 980 Ti
Price: ₹10,649



GeForce GTX 960
Price: ₹16,250

clock of 1216 MHz and a build quality that few bother to top. It's 12+2-phase VRM circuitry should be more than sufficient for it to be coveted by overclockers and it isn't lacking in the cooling department either. MSI's GTX 980TI GAMING 6G isn't that far behind but with only so many places on the podium, it lost out but it's nevertheless worthy of a mention.

Best buy

GeForce GTX 960

The GTX 960 sure happens to be priced appropriately for most Indian gamers. If we were to look at the international scene, then the GTX 970 seems more deserving of the Best Buy award but since India happens to be a more price conscious market the GTX 960 is better suited. Comparing prices on top ecommerce sites in India, we found that these cards can be obtained for as low as ₹16,250. Specifically, the Gigabyte GTX 960 Gaming G1 carried this price tag at the time of writing this section but we understand that prices fluctuate and some other SKU might be better priced by the time you check the prices so we'll have to be brand agnostic here as well.